

Women in Aquaculture

Career Planning Toolkit

Templates & Worksheets for Your Career

Women in Aquaculture (WiA)

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This publication is produced by Women in Aquaculture (WiA), a global non-profit platform connecting, supporting and celebrating women across the aquaculture industry.

How to Use This Toolkit

This toolkit helps you take stock of where you are, define where you want to go, and create a practical plan to get there. Work through the sections in order, or jump to the areas most relevant to your situation.

Self-Assessment

Rate yourself 1-5 in each area (1 = beginner, 5 = expert):

- Technical skills in your area of aquaculture
 - Leadership and management capabilities
 - Communication and presentation skills
 - Professional network and industry connections
 - Business and financial literacy
 - Research and analytical abilities
 - Confidence in your abilities and direction
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Goal Setting

Define your career vision for the next 1, 3, and 5 years:

- What role or position do I aspire to?
- What skills do I need to develop?
- What experiences will help me get there?
- Who can help me on this journey?
- What barriers might I face, and how can I address them?

CV & Cover Letter Tips

In aquaculture, employers value:

- **Practical experience** — farm work, field research, processing operations
 - **Technical certifications** — water quality, feed management, biosecurity
 - **Cross-cultural experience** — working across regions and communities
 - **Leadership examples** — team management, project coordination
 - **Impact metrics** — production improvements, cost savings, sustainability outcomes
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Interview Preparation

Common questions in aquaculture interviews:

- Tell us about your experience with [specific species/technique]
 - How have you handled a biosecurity or water quality challenge?
 - Describe a time you led a team or managed a project
 - What do you see as the biggest challenges facing aquaculture?
 - How do you approach sustainability in your work?
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30-Day Networking Plan

Week 1

Update your LinkedIn profile. Connect with 10 people in aquaculture. Join the WiA community.

Week 2

Attend one webinar or online event. Introduce yourself in the WiA community forum.

Week 3

Follow up with a speaker or panellist from the event. Share an insight or article with your network.

Week 4

Reach out to someone you admire for a virtual coffee. Reflect on what you've learned and set next month's goals.